INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PACKAGING AND PACKING OF OFFICE PARTITIONS, PORTABLE, FABRIC COVERED

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington DC 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the packaging, packing, material handling provision, and marking requirements for portable fabric covered office partitions (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

NN-P-71 - Pallets, Material Handling, Wood, Stringer Construction, 2-Way and 4-Way (Partial).
QQ-S-781 - Strapping, Steel, Flat and Round.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101 - Preservation, Packaging, Packing Materials: Test Procedures.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liner, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water Vapor Proof, or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

FSC PACK

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. Materials used in the packaging, packing, palletization and marking of the fabric covered office partitions shall be as specified herein and in the applicable specifications.

3.1.1 Fiberboard box. The fiberboard box used herein shall conform to PPP-B-636, style optional, type CF, class domestic, variety SW, Grade 200 minimum, unless otherwise specified herein.

3.1.2 Steel Strapping. The steel strapping used as specified herein shall conform with QQ-S-781, class 1, type I or IV regular duty, finish B, Grade 2. The size of the strapping shall be as specified herein.

3.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1 Level A and B.

3.2.1.1 Partition panel and partition assembly. Each partition panel shall be wrapped, covered or cushioned with nonabrasive material to prevent abrasion and damage when tested as specified (see 4.3). One pair of class 1, leg assemblies shall be immobilized in die-cut fiberboard forms or secured to a fiberboard sheet with tape or shrink film. Alternatively, the legs shall be wrapped to prevent metal to metal contact and packaged in a tight fitting box or folder.

3.2.1.2 Partition accessories. Each partition accessory shall be wrapped to prevent abrasion and metal to metal contact and packaged in a close fitting fiberboard box. The box shall be as specified in 3.1.1. The fastening hardware as bolts, nuts, screw, etc., shall be packaged in a fabric, kraft or polyethylene bag and the bag opening secured to prevent loss of contents. The bagged hardware, when applicable, shall be included in the pack. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

3.2.2 Level C. Each partition panel, partition assembly and partition accessories shall be prepared for packing to insure adequate protection against abrasion and damage during shipment.

3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Level A.

3.3.1.1 Partition panel and partition assembly. Each partition panel or partition assembly, packed and tested as specified in 3.3.2.1, shall be re-packed in a vertical up-right position, in quantities of five or as specified (see 6.2) in a box conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, styles C or I; PPP-B-636, grade V3C; or PPP-B-640, class 2. The contents of each box shall be waterproofed by means of case liners constructed and sealed in accordance with MIL-L-10547. The box shall be closed and strapped or reinforced in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

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3.3.1.2 Partition accessories. Partition accessories packaged as specified in 3.2.1.2 shall be packed in quantities as specified (see 6.2) in a tight fitting box conforming to PPP-P-636, grade V3c minimum, style optional. The box shall be closed and waterproofed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

3.3.2 Level B.

3.3.2.1 Partition panel and partition assembly. Each partition panel or partition assembly (one panel and a pair of leg assemblies) packaged as specified in 3.2.1.1 shall be packed in a tight fitting fiberboard box. The box shall be as specified in 3.1.1, grade 275 minimum. Form fitting corner pads, molded or folded, shall be inserted over each corner of the partition panel to provide not less than 5/8 inch clearance between the partition and the inside walls of the box. Additional forms shall be used as required to maintain the 5/8 inch minimum clearances and to provide the necessary stacking strength when tested as specified in 4.3. The packaged leg assemblies shall be secured to prevent movement within the pack. A printed assembly instruction sheet and parts list shall be included in each pack. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636, except that strapping shall not be used as a method of closure. The packed box shall be tested as specified in 4.3.

3.3.2.2 Partition accessories. Partition accessories packaged as specified in 3.2.1.2 shall be packed in a box as specified in 3.1.1. The quantity per box shall be as specified (see 6.2). The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

3.3.3 Level C. Each partition panel, partition assembly or partition accessories, packaged as specified in 3.2.2, shall be packed in a box that will assure acceptance and safe delivery in compliance with National Motor Freight Classification item 82540 or the Uniform Freight Classification item 44160.

3.4 Material handling provisions. Partition panels and partition assemblies for level A packing shall be palletized in accordance with 3.4.1, when the requirements of the box specification do not provide access for material handling equipment, unless otherwise specified herein.

3.4.1 Palletization.

3.4.1.1 Partition panels and partition assemblies. Partition panels and partition assemblies packed as specified in 3.3.1.1 shall be palletized on a pallet conforming to NN-P-71, type III, four-way, except that the pallet shall be constructed with three stringers. The length and width of the pallet shall be equal to the respective outside length and width of the load. The shipping container shall be strapped to the pallet with two steel straps, 3/4" x .020" minimum, conforming to material as specified in 3.1.2. One end strap, placed 6 inches in from each end of the load, shall be applied around the front, top and back of the load and under the bottom side of the top deckboards of the pallet. Metal edge protectors shall be used under the straps at the top edges of the shipping container. Each strap shall be tensioned to prevent the load from shifting on the pallet.

3.4.1.2 Partition accessories. Partition accessories shall not require palletization.

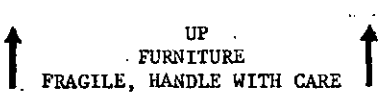
3.5 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, as specified (see 6.2).

3.5.1 Civil agencies. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

3.5.2 Military activities. Each shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

3.5.3 Special marking. In addition to the markings required by 3.5.1 or 3.5.2, each shipping container shall be marked as follows (ref. figure A):

(a) On the side panel:



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(b) In an upper corner of both end panels, a standard up arrow.

(c) On the top panel:

TOP
THIS SIDE UP

(d) To facilitate color identification, the front and one end panel of each shipping container shall have an area approximately 3 x 8 inches painted to match the color of the unit packed. Alternatively, adhesive-backed color panels of the size specified above shall be applied to the container.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, the supplier is responsible for insuring that the packaging and packing materials used are manufactured, tested, and inspected in accordance with the requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards to the extent specified; or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. An inspection shall be made to determine compliance with the requirements of section 3.

4.2.1 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1.1 Inspection of preparation for delivery. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers offered for acceptance at one time. The inspection level shall be S-4, with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred unit. The supplier shall make available to the inspection team two sets of reference packing assembly drawings along with component packing part drawings to expedite the inspection.

4.2.2 Classification of defects. Defects noted in the inspection shall be scored in accordance with table I.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, wrong location, illegible.
Materials	Packaging materials not as specified, missing, damaged, or non-serviceable.
Workmanship	Containers inadequately closed, poor application of internal packing parts, moveable or loose parts not secured properly.

4.2.3 Testing.

4.2.3.1 Test report. The tests specified herein are intended to determine compliance with the requirements for level B packing and shall be required on one model identical to the item being packed in the contract or order. A test report indicating no damage to the test item and no functional damage to the container and packing will be accepted as proof of compliance for the level of packing specified in the contract or order when made available to the inspection service. The test results shall be obtained from tests conducted on an item of the identical model specified in the contract or order. Test results obtained as a result of tests conducted within 12 months prior to date of contract or order, shall contain a complete description of the packaging and packing materials used and items packed.

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A packed item, tested after date of contract or order, shall be made available for identification by the Government representative and remain at the contractor's plant until the last shipment on the contract is made. This unit shall be used as a guide in determining that packed items furnished in the context of the contract conform to the sample unit tested and accepted. At the option of the Government, tests performed by the manufacturer or a qualified laboratory shall be witnessed by a Government inspector.

4.2.3.2 Testing costs. All costs relating to the tests, including damaged units, shall be at the expense of the contractor or manufacturer.

4.2.3.3 Examination after testing. After the specified tests for level B have been accomplished, a visual examination shall be made of the shipping container and its contents. Any damage to the contents or functional damage to the container or packing shall be cause for rejection. Structural damage to the container, which would result in either loss of the contents or failure of the container in subsequent handling, shall be cause for rejection. Substantial shifting of contents within the container that would create conditions likely to cause damage during shipment, storage, and reshipment shall be cause for rejection. Minor container damage, such as chipping, abrasion, and superficial splitting of wood members and punctures of container panels, shall not be cause for rejection.

4.3 Test methods. The following tests cover procedures for preshipment testing of one packed item for level B packing. A test cycle in the order herein specified shall consist of all the tests required for a specific shipment.

4.3.1 Incline-impact test. The incline-impact test shall be in accordance with method 5023 of Fed. Test Method No. 101 with one exception. The packed unit shall be impacted on each of the four smallest surface areas only.

4.3.2 Vibration test. The vibration test shall be in accordance with method 5019 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101. The packed unit shall be placed on the vibration table in the position in which it will be shipped (vertical up-right) and vibrated for 1 hour. At the end of this time, the packed unit shall be horizontally rotated 90 degrees from its orginal position and vibrated for an additional hour.

4.3.3 Drop test. The edgewise drop (rotational) test shall be in accordance with method 5008 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 101. The drop height shall be 27 inches. The packed unit shall be in its vertical up-right shipping position when the test is applied once to each end of the container. The same test shall be applied to the top of the container by turning the unit over and performing the test.

4.3.4 Superimposed-load test. The superimposed-load test shall be used to determine the ability of the pack to provide sufficient protection to its contents, when subjected to loads imposed by warehouse stacking. The test shall be performed on a compression machine or on a flat rigid floor. The packed unit shall be turned and laid flat on its largest surface. Three pieces of wood dunnage, (1 x 4, 1 x 6 or 2 x 4 material), shall be laid across the top of the container to dispense the weight of the superimposed load over the area of contact and to the sides of the box. The length of the dunnage shall extend 3 inches (± 1") beyond the ends of the load. One wood dunnage shall be placed 4 inches (± 1") in from each side edge and the third member centered between the two. The prescribed load shall be applied or superimposed equally over the wood dunnage. The test shall be for a period of 1 hour and the prescribed load determined as follows:

$$\text{Stacking load (pounds)} = A \times \frac{(B-C)}{C} \times D$$

Where: A = Weight of loaded container.
B = Allowed stacking height - 15 foot minimum.
C = Height of container (feet).
D = Safety factor - 1.25.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

This section is not applicable to this specification.

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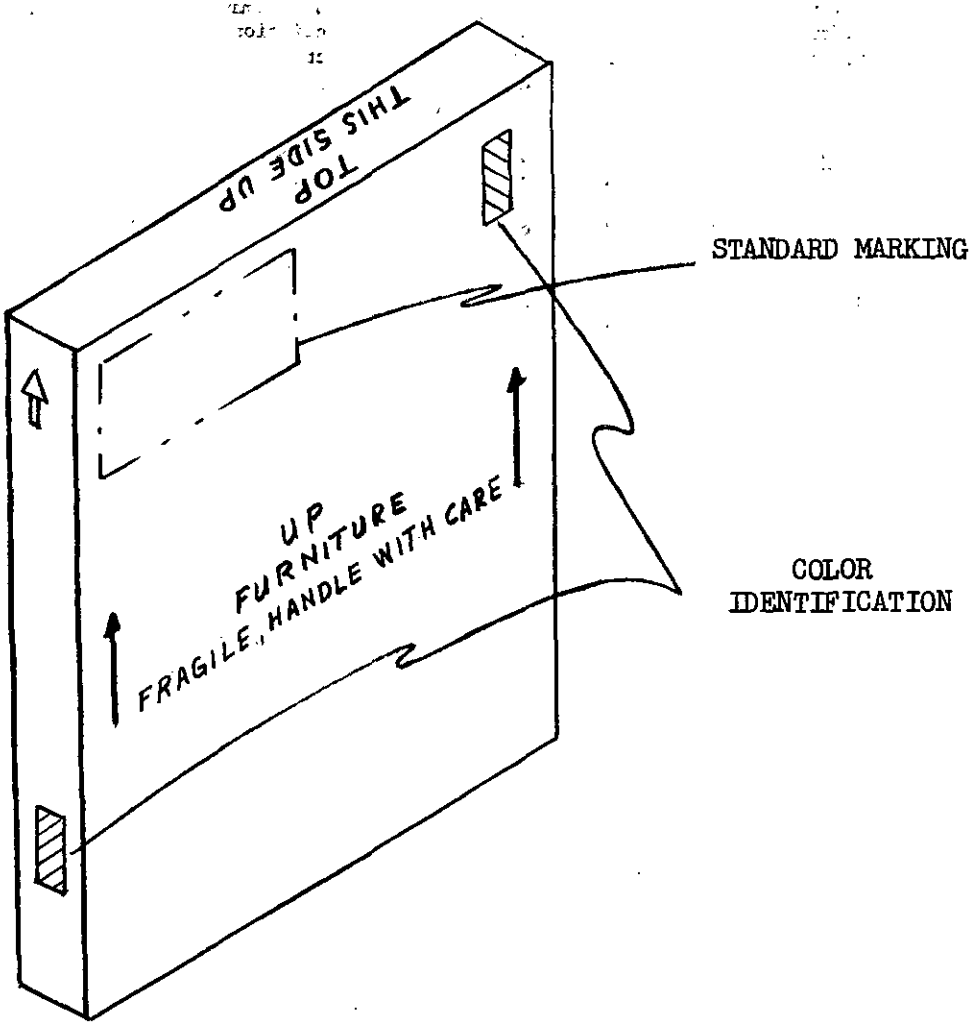


FIGURE A
SPECIAL MARKING

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The requirements of this specification are intended to be used for the packaging, packing, marking and the preshipment performance type testing, for fabric covered office partitions as covered by Purchase Description FMSF 71-1D. It is intended for application to assembly line mass-produced products. Provisions for material handling equipment access and palletization also form a part of the requirements as specified herein.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Packaging level required (see 3.2).
(c) Packing level required (see 3.3).
(d) Material handling provisions (see 3.4).
(e) Type of marking required (see 3.5).

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